

## FILM REVIEW

VEER

## Comic Epic

RATING ★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆

Director: Anil Sharma

Starring: Salman Khan,  
Zarine Khan

Salman Khan is the warrior Asterix and his Pindari tribe are the Gauls standing up to the mighty Romans. Rubbix? Not quite. That's the comic book spirit that pervades *Veer* and one suspects quite unintentionally. Heads are not just severed, they fly in the air; arms are not just cut, they do a somersault; and blood doesn't just spurt, it gushes. The savage Pindaris drink, dress and cuss like the Gauls,



while the English divide the country. There are stirring speeches about the motherland by Salman, who plays a Pindari sent to England to learn the ways of the wicked to outsmart them. Clearly he takes a detour because he comes back looking like Brad Pitt's Achilles in *Troy*. The film takes

and grab a pound of flesh. With every such act, the operatic chorus rises a notch. This is melodramatic direction at its heightened worst. Every Bollywood star has the right to have his own personal epic but think of it as Salman's *Asoka*, not *Lagaan*.

by Kaveree Bamzai

## THEATRE

## Smiles and TEARS

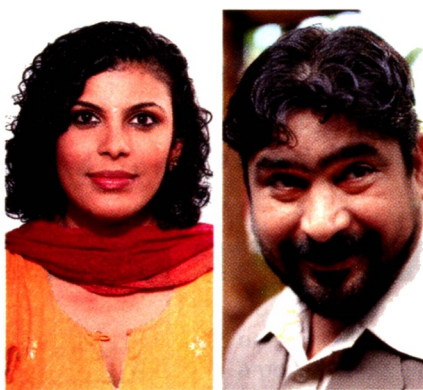
Put together by Rage, *One on One* explores everything that wrestles to find space in metropolitan minds today. In this series of short plays, the audiences will come face to face with truth as it unveils both hilarious and tragic issues through 10 monologues to stir Mumbai's conscience. On January 26 at the Tata Theatre, NCPA, Mumbai.

## Anu Menon, 27, Actor

Popularly known as Lola Kutty, Menon plays the role of an ordinary citizen affected by the political system. The play titled *The Interrogation* has been penned by writer Shiv Subrahmaniam. It is a portrayal of how the state and the system affect an ordinary individual.

## Yashpal Sharma, 40, Actor

*Kachre ki Hifaazat* is a portrayal of

(CLOCKWISE FROM LEFT) MENON,  
SHARMA, MISTRY AND DACUNHA

the point of view of a bodyguard. Sharma plays the guard to the chief minister. The artist is best known for his role as Randhir Singh in Sudhir Mishra's *Hazaaron Khwaishein Aisi* and as Lakha in Aamir Khan's *Lagaan*.

## Amit Mistry, 36, Actor

If 26/11 accused Ajmal Kasab's whims and fancies have taken us aback, Mistry is set to play a similar character in *Instant Behosh*. Written by Rahul DaCunha, the play is about a terrorist who aspires to be a dancer.

Rahul DaCunha, 47,  
Writer/Director

DaCunha who set a trend with his monologues *Going Solo* returns to find it exciting even after a decade of his first encounter with the form. In *Bash*, the artist gives his own take on Section 377 of the IPC. The play has two urban characters responding to the newly formed laws on homosexuality.

by Harsha Bhat